1951

F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

FJ 1022/631

82

FROM
U.S.C.D'A.
LONDON

No.

Dated 21/6/51.

Received in Registry 26/6/51

Transmits message from Dulles informing Secretary of State of U.S. Decision not to issue formal statement on "Chinese participation & Formosa" in the J.P.T., at this time..

REFERENCES

[FJ 1022/630]
[FJ 1022/629]

MINUTES

(A) F.O. Minute - C.H. JOHNSTON (21/6/51)

↓ 27/6.

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)	(Index)
Ltr 28/6	3/8/51

39451

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SECRET

83 F

American Embassy, London
June 21, 1951

FJ 1022/631

Dear Mr. Morrison:

I have been asked by Ambassador Dulles to pass the following personal message to you:

"We are disposed not to issue at this time any formal statement on 'Chinese participation and Formosa' not because we have in any way altered our views as set out in the draft statement and corresponding treaty Article 26, but because we think it more useful quietly to consolidate support for that position before issuing a statement which under present circumstances would surely attract counter-statements and perhaps political controversy within our countries which can perhaps be avoided or minimized by the procedure now suggested. Already there are some indications of approval here in quarters which we anticipated might be publicly antagonistic and we think it may be possible to avoid the type of controversial situation in anticipation of which an early issuance of the statement was originally planned.

"The Secretary and I will have to meet press inquiries of various kinds. We would, however, hope to satisfy legitimate interest by stating the nature of the problem, that it is being studied with various governments, and we would adhere wholly to the spirit and intent of the draft statement. Best regards."

Sincerely yours,

J. B. Johnson

The Right Honorable H. S. Morrison, M.P.,

Foreign Office, S.W.1.

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SECRET:

84

JAPANESE PEACE TREATY

FJ 1022/631

Mr. Ringwalt, United States Embassy, handed me this afternoon the attached letter from the United States Chargé d'Affaires conveying a personal message from Mr. Dulles to the Secretary of State.

Mr. Ringwalt also showed me a telegram from the State Department instructing the United States Embassy to inform us as follows. The draft Treaty is being closely studied by the interested departments of the United States Government. This study will probably not be concluded before next week. It may result in the recommendation of some minor textual changes, none of which involve points which were under discussion between us. The State Department anticipate no change in substance.

Mr. Dulles's message amplifies the information already given us by the Embassy in Washington about the United States' wish to postpone the issue of the agreed statement, but suggests that this postponement must now be regarded as indefinite. On our present evidence, there is, I think, no need to suspect a sinister motive behind this. Mr. Dulles's talks with congressional leaders seem in fact to have gone better than expected, so that he now regards it as safe to work for the acceptance of our agreed policy by more gradual means rather than by issuing the statement, which would have been bound to give rise to controversy in the United States. In this decision, he has no doubt been influenced by the course of the MacArthur hearings, which are now petering out after failing completely to discredit the administration.

Our Embassy in Washington support this interpretation. From what the State Department have told them, there seems no need to connect the United States' decision to postpone the announcement with the statement made by the "Foreign Minister"

of /

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Enclo

SECRET:

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JAPANESE PEACE TREATY [FJ 1022/631]

Flag A
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Presumably this will be communicated to the Embassy.

Mr. Dulles's message amplifies the information already given us by the Embassy in Washington about the United States' wish to postpone the issue of the agreed statement, but suggests that this postponement must now be regarded as indefinite. On our present evidence, there is, I think, no need to suspect a sinister motive behind this. Mr. Dulles's talks with congressional leaders seem in fact to have gone better than expected, so that he now regards it as safe to work for the acceptance of our agreed policy by more gradual means rather than by issuing the statement, which would have been bound to give rise to controversy in the United States. In this decision, he has no doubt been influenced by the course of the MacArthur hearings, which are now petering out after failing completely to discredit the administration.

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of Chiang Kai Shek on June 14th declaring that "the Nationalist Government had consistently upheld its right to take part in the Japanese Peace Treaty on an equal footing with the other Allied Powers and that, whatever form the Treaty might eventually take, it could not accept any discriminatory arrangement on this point". It was in fact to be expected that the Nationalist Government would take this line as soon as they heard of the proposed compromise, as it was inevitable that they would.

As our own original proposal was that the announcement should be issued at a later stage in the Treaty negotiations, and it was the Americans who originally pressed for its early release,, there seems no reason to object to the suggested postponement. The only disadvantage, which we have already pointed out to the United States Government, is that we had already told Commonwealth Governments and the French and Netherlands Embassies here about it before we heard, at the last moment, of the United States' wish to postpone it, so that there is a slightly increased risk of leakage for this reason. That risk should presumably be accepted.

Recommendations. In view of the last paragraph of Mr. Dulles's message, it may be thought that, while clearly nothing should be issued officially here, we might authorise the News Department to use the agreed statement as a basis for guidance to the more responsible British correspondents.

We must report these new developments, and the decisions taken on them, together with the action of the Cabinet in generally approving a draft Treaty this morning, by telegraph to Washington, Tokyo and the other posts concerned.

Copies of this minute are being submitted to the Minister of State and Sir William Strang.

In view of Mr. Steel's letter of June 18th to Sir William Strang, the Secretary of State may wish at the same time to send a friendly message to Mr. Dulles. I submit a draft.

Flag B
[F5022/630]

C.H. Johnston

(C.H. Johnston)

21st June, 1951.

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22/6

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Since dictating the above I learn in strict confidence from Mr. Ringwalt, United States Embassy, that certain influences inside the United States Government which are interested in supporting Chiang Kai Shek are trying to secure a reversal of the agreement reached by Mr. Dulles with H.M. Government about Chinese participation. The United States Embassy are telegraphing to say that any such move would be most impolitic. Mr. Ringwalt said he thought that this development had had nothing whatever to do with the decision to postpone the agreed announcement.

Our best line will probably be to behave as if the possibility of this did not exist, but to warn the Embassy in Washington about it so that they can leave the State Department in no doubt of our attitude should the question be brought up.

C.H. Johnston.

(C.H. Johnston)
22nd June, 1951.

KGH 22/6.
Minister of State
Secretary of State

W. Strang
22/6

Flag C
[FJ1022/629]

A personal letter from Mr. Dulles has now arrived, enclosing a copy of the Press Release. Reference to it has been incorporated in the draft telegram.

T.J. Bewlman
22/6

Seen by News Dept.
Seen by Sir E. Dening - please see letter at Flag C.
C.H. Johnston. 25-vi.

Telegrams sent despatched A. Ford. 28/6

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F.T. Hemelryk
22/6

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25.vi.

Telegrams sent
Despatched.
D. Grant. 22/6.